5. It seems that both ‘cremation and burying were practiced by megalithic people. Criteria for selecting cremation or burying the dead was probably based on age, sex and nature of the death as has been observed from the ethnographic study on mortuary variability in Vidarbha’. Mohanty, R. K. and T. Thakuria, ‘Early Iron Age Megalithic Culture of Peninsular Indian and South India’, *History of Ancient India*, Vol. 3, pp. 343–78, edited by D. Charkrabarti and M. Lal, Aryan Publishers and Vivekananda Center, New Delhi, 2014.
6. Sukumaran, Ajay, ‘A Flame beneath the Ground’, *Outlook India*, 2017, https://www.outlookindia.com/magazine/story/a-flame-beneath-the-ground/298344.
7. ‘Note from Nehru to the Minister for Education, dated December 10, 1955, Guntur, Ministry of Education, C.I, 1955, file no. 3-125/55 C.I, pp. 19–20, NAI.’ This source appears in Singh, Upinder, *The Idea of Ancient India*, SAGE Publications, 2016.
8. Sarkar, H. and Mishra, B.N., *Nagarjunakonda*, 2006, pp. 19–20.
9. Soundararajan, K.V. (editor), R. Subrahmanyam, et al., *Nagarjunakonda (1954–60)*, Vol. II, ASI, 2006, p. 143.
10. Ibid, p. 593–94.
11. Krishna Murthy, K., *Nagarjunakonda: A Cultural Study*, Concept Publishing Company, 1977, p. 16.
12. Soundararajan, K.V. (editor), Subrahmanyam, R., et al., *Nagarjunakonda (1954–60)*, Vol. II, ASI, 2006, p. 226.
13. Ibid, pp. 242–43. Other scholars, such as A.S. Altekar, have argued that sati was extremely rare during this period in India, especially in the Deccan, and was mainly a Kshatriya practice.
14. Apparently, in some monks’ cells, archaeologists found ‘a lump of lead ore and an earthenware die for the manufacture of coins of this size and pattern, indicating that the monks minted their own coins’. Longhurst, A.H., *Buddhist Antiquities of Nagarjunakonda*, ASI, 1938, p. 10.
15. Stone, Elizabeth R., *The Buddhist Art of Nagarjunakonda*, Motilal Banarsidass, Delhi, 1994, p. 30.
16. Soundararajan, K.V. (editor), Subrahmanyam, R., et al., *Nagarjunakonda (1954–60)*, ASI, 2006, Volume II, p. 107.
17. ‘This is not a particularly far-fetched interpretation, and corroborates the suggested connection between Buddhist monasteries and healing